



WHITE-PAPER

The QuickBooks to NetSuite Transition: A Guide for Growing Businesses



Unlock business growth by shedding that basic QuickBooks accounting program in favor of NetSuite's robust, cloud-based enterprise resource planning platform.

Growing companies quickly transcend the capabilities of basic accounting programs like QuickBooks, yet this affordable DIY platform continues to be a popular choice for startups. As those startups become bigger entities, they need more than just a basic accounting platform.

While simple tools like QuickBooks may suffice for very small businesses, they simply can't scale with increasing complexity. As a business expands, for example, it may add new locations, start doing business overseas, expand its payroll and/or adhere to stricter regulatory requirements. All growing companies also need transparent reporting, real-time data and user-friendly dashboards—all of which support good decision-making.

With its limited functionality, QuickBooks can become a bottleneck pretty quickly, hindering operational efficiency and informed decision-making. This is one of many reasons why growing organizations embrace more comprehensive and integrated solutions, with NetSuite enterprise resource planning (ERP) being a prime target for many of these companies.

QuickBooks for NetSuite: Not a Like-for-Like Exchange

Migrating from QuickBooks to NetSuite is a transformative and strategic decision that can significantly enhance and streamline your company's financial management capabilities. This migration supports more robust and scalable financial operations, provides better insights and gives you more control over your financial data.



Once in place, NetSuite provides advanced features like real-time financial reporting, data analytics and dashboards, automated processes and improved regulatory compliance, among other wins. These enhancements help teams members save time, make better decisions and operate more productively.

Unfortunately, switching out QuickBooks for NetSuite isn't a "like-for-like" exchange; it's a significant shift that requires careful planning and execution. NetSuite is a comprehensive ERP with a much broader scope than QuickBooks. This means a more complex implementation process that incorporates data migration, user training, system customization and myriad other steps.

Brace Yourself for a Host of New Functionalities

NetSuite offers a wide range of features and functionalities that QuickBooks doesn't offer, including:

- **Advanced financial management capabilities.** NetSuite provides more sophisticated accounting and financial management tools, such as multi-currency management, fixed asset management, revenue recognition, multi-subsidiary consolidation, and budgeting and forecasting.
- **Robust inventory management.** Growing companies running on QuickBooks will eventually need an additional inventory solution, as QuickBooks can only handle very simple wholesale distribution or manufacturing operations. NetSuite, on the other hand, offers advanced inventory management features like demand planning, order management, and advanced shipping and fulfillment options.
- **Integrated customer relationship management (CRM).** NetSuite comes with a built-in CRM that you can use to manage customer interactions and data in one place. By integrating seamlessly with other NetSuite modules like ERP and e-commerce, the CRM eliminates data silos and provides real-time insights into customer interactions, sales trends and key performance indicators (KPIs).

Data migration may present substantial roadblocks on the path from basic programs like QuickBooks to more advanced, cloud-based platform like NetSuite.

Before migration can happen, all existing data must be carefully **assessed, cleansed, transformed and validated to ensure accuracy and avoid disruptions.**

The time it takes to switch from QuickBooks to NetSuite varies depending on the complexity of your business operations, the amount of data you need to migrate, and the level of customization required.

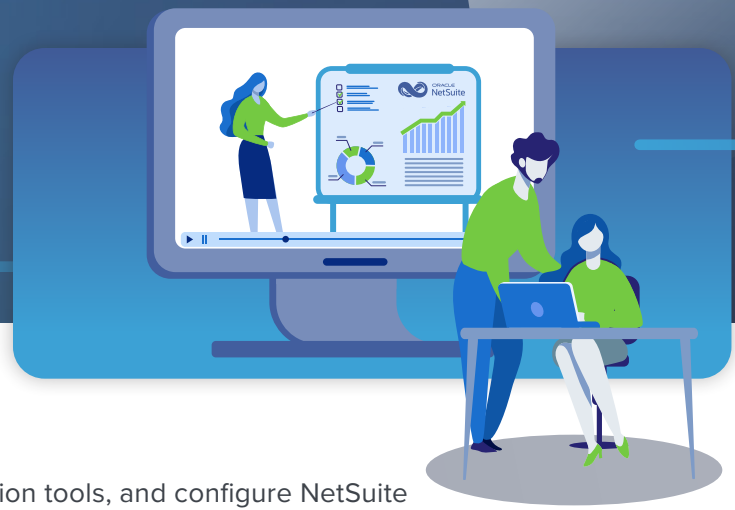
- **E-commerce and omnichannel capabilities.** The ERP empowers businesses to deliver seamless and personalized customer experiences across all touchpoints. By unifying online and offline channels, NetSuite provides a single source of truth for customer data, inventory, and orders, enabling businesses to gain a 360-degree view of their customers and optimize operations accordingly.
- **Project management.** NetSuite allows you to manage projects, including tracking time and expenses and project profitability. This integration eliminates the need for manual data entry and reconciliation between disparate systems, streamlines workflows and minimizes the risk of errors.
- **Customized workflows and processes.** NetSuite is highly customizable, allowing you to tailor the software to your business needs, including creating custom fields, workflows and reports. This level of customization helps the ERP integrate with existing business processes and adapt to each organization's unique needs.
- **Industry-specific versions that tailored to different industries.** These versions include preconfigured solutions, best practices and industry-specific features that help organizations implement the ERP faster and with less customization required. Some of NetSuite's industry-specific versions include retail, manufacturing, wholesale distribution, services and non-profit.

10 Steps to a Successful NetSuite Implementation

1. **Evaluate your current setup.** The first step is to evaluate your current setup; start by inventorying and assessing the quality of your data, ensuring accuracy and completeness. Document your current workflows, and customizations, and identify any pain points or limitations.

Backup your data and consult with key stakeholders to gather input and set expectations. Review your integration needs and ensure compliance with regulatory and security requirements. This thorough evaluation will help you plan and execute a smooth migration to NetSuite.

2. **Plan your migration strategy.** Define clear objectives and the scope of the migration. Assemble a dedicated team, including a project manager and key stakeholders, and consider hiring external consultants like GSI. Develop a detailed migration plan with timelines, resource allocation, and risk management.



Prepare and clean your data, choose the right migration tools, and configure NetSuite to match your business needs. Migrate your data in phases, conduct thorough testing, and provide comprehensive training for your team. Finally, go live with NetSuite and offer ongoing support to ensure a smooth transition.

- 3. Prepare your data.** Audit your data to ensure accuracy and completeness. Clean up your data by removing duplicates, updating missing information, and archiving old records. Standardize data formats to match NetSuite's requirements and create comprehensive backups.

Map QuickBooks fields to NetSuite fields and run test migrations to identify any issues. Validate the migrated data and document the entire process for future reference. These steps will help ensure a smooth and accurate data migration.

- 4. Choose the right integration tools.** Identify your data types and volume. Research popular tools like Celigo, Boomi, and NetSuite Connector, comparing their features, ease of use, and compatibility with your systems. Look for automation and customization options and conduct a test integration to evaluate performance.

Consider the cost and potential ROI, and ensure that the tool meets your business needs and offers reliable support. These steps will help you select the best tool for a smooth and efficient integration with other systems.

- 5. Migrate your data.** Export your data using QuickBooks' export tools and map the fields to match NetSuite's requirements. Clean and format your data, then use NetSuite's CSV import tools to upload it. Conduct test imports to identify and resolve any issues, ensuring data accuracy.

Once you're confident in the migration process, you can move forward with the full data import and monitor the process closely. Finally, validate the migrated data through reconciliation and user acceptance testing to ensure everything is accurate and meets business needs.

- 6. Configure and customize NetSuite.** Enter your company information and set global preferences. Create custom fields and records to capture unique data and modify forms and layouts to match your business processes. Use SuiteFlow to automate workflows, and design custom dashboards and reports tailored to different roles.

Define user roles and permissions to control access and utilize SuiteBuilder and SuiteScript for advanced customizations. These steps will help you tailor NetSuite to your specific business needs and improve overall efficiency.

- 7. Put your new ERP to the test.** Validate data integrity and field mapping accuracy. Conduct functional testing on core processes and custom workflows and involve end users in user acceptance testing (UAT) to gather feedback. Perform performance testing to ensure the system handles data volume and user activity efficiently and verify security measures and access controls.

Test integrations with third-party applications and conduct regression testing after any updates. Document issues and provide additional user training based on feedback and testing results to ensure a smooth transition.

- 8. Assess your team's training needs and develop a tailored training plan.** Some of the comprehensive resources at your avail include NetSuite's Learning Center, webinars and workshops. Conduct role-based, interactive training sessions and provide ongoing support through a help desk and regular check-ins.

Encourage certification for deeper expertise and track progress, adjusting the plan as needed based on feedback. This approach ensures your team is well-prepared to use NetSuite effectively.

- 9. Go live, monitor and tweak accordingly.** Plan a go-live date that minimizes business disruption and communicates it to all stakeholders. Ensure final data backups and system checks are completed. Transition to NetSuite on the planned date and monitor the system closely for any issues. Provide post-go-live support with a dedicated team and regular check-ins.

Continuously monitor system performance and data integrity, collect user feedback, and implement a continuous improvement process to optimize the system based on user needs and business requirements.

GSI also offers

Comprehensive assessments:

GSI will thoroughly evaluate your current QuickBooks setup, identifying any potential issues and ensuring your data is ready for migration.

Strategic planning: We'll help you develop a detailed migration plan, including timelines, resource allocation, and risk management.

Data preparation and migration:

GSI's experts will assist in cleaning and formatting your data, ensuring a smooth and accurate migration to NetSuite.

Customization and configuration:

We will help configure and customize NetSuite to meet your specific business needs, ensuring you get the most out of your new system.

Training and support: GSI provides comprehensive training for your team and ongoing support to ensure a smooth transition and continued success with NetSuite.

Long-term after-sale support:

GSI's managed services for NetSuite provide ongoing support, optimization, and administration, allowing businesses to maximize their ERP investment while focusing on their core operations.

Get the right implementation partner in your corner. Don't go it alone. GSI has helped many businesses transition away from basic accounting platforms like QuickBooks and over to the robust, cloud-based NetSuite platform. GSI's expert team will assist through every step of the migration process, from evaluating your current setup to going live and monitoring your new system.

Ready, Set, Go!

Implementing enterprise software is a multifaceted endeavor that takes significant time, resources (both internal and external) and careful consideration. By proactively addressing potential challenges, fostering strong stakeholder buy-in and maintaining a flexible approach, organizations can navigate all of these complexities on the road to a successful NetSuite implementation.

Ultimately, all businesses implementing NetSuite need help from a partner that's both an expert the ERP and that's ready and able to consult on the company's top pain points and objectives. With a knowledgeable implementation and support partner in its corner, your organization will roll out a transformative business software system that addresses its current pain points and prepares it for future growth.

As the **#1 Ranked NetSuite Solution Provider** by G2, GSI has a senior-level, 100% U.S.-based NetSuite implementation and support teams that average 10+ years of experience in the ERP's ecosystem. By partnering with GSI, you can ensure a seamless migration from QuickBooks to NetSuite, allowing your business to take full advantage of this modern, cloud-based ERP's powerful financial management capabilities.

